

Skills Summary

Mixed Facts Within 20

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Adding within 20: make a ten

Rule: Break one number apart to make a ten first. Tens are easy to add on.

Example: $8 + 6$

Step 1. Both parts are known and we want the total — this is adding, and making a ten makes it fast.

Step 2. 8 needs 2 to make 10. Break 6 into 2 and 4: $8 + 2 = 10$, then $10 + 4 = 14$.

$$\Rightarrow 8 + 6 = 14$$

Try it: $7 + 6$

check: 13

Subtracting within 20: count up

Rule: To take away, you can count UP from the smaller number to the bigger one. The jumps you count are the answer.

Example: $15 - 8$

Step 1. The whole and one part are known and we want what is left — this is subtracting, and counting up avoids counting backwards.

Step 2. From 8 up to 10 is 2 jumps; from 10 up to 15 is 5 more. $2 + 5 = 7$.

$$\Rightarrow 15 - 8 = 7$$

Try it: $14 - 8$

check: 6

Missing numbers: use the fact family

Rule: Addition and subtraction share fact families. If a part is missing, subtract the known part from the whole. If the whole is missing, add the parts.

Example: $6 + \square = 14$

Step 1. First decide what is missing — here the whole 14 is known, so the blank is a part: subtract to find it.

Step 2. $14 - 6 = 8$. Check: $6 + 8 = 14$. It works!

$$\Rightarrow 6 + 8 = 14$$

Try it: $9 + \square = 16$

check: 7

(!) Watch out: Read before you work! In a mixed set, some problems add, some take away, and some hide a number. Ask first: what is missing — a part, or the whole?